

Word family: **clock / clocks / clocked / clocking / clockwise / counterclockwise**

Base word: clock

Part of speech: mainly **noun** and **verb**

Related forms:

* **clock** (n.) — 時鐘；計時裝置

* **clock** (v.) — 記錄時間 / 速度；達到某速度；觀察到；打卡

* **clocked** — 已記錄時間 / 速度的；被認出 / 注意到的

* **clocking** — 計時；打卡；記錄

* **clockwise** — 順時針方向

* **counterclockwise** — 逆時針方向

* **clockwork** — 鐘錶機械裝置；像鐘錶般規律

* **clock in / clock on** — 上班打卡

* **clock out / clock off** — 下班打卡

* **against the clock** — 爭分奪秒；與時間競賽

* **around the clock** — 晝夜不停；二十四小時不停

* **turn back the clock** — 讓時間倒流；回到從前

* **biological clock** — 生理時鐘

* **body clock** — 生理時鐘

* **the clock is ticking** — 時間正在流逝；剩餘時間不多

Meaning in this passage

> I was always **racing against the clock**, leaving things until the last minute...

Here, **clock** appears in the fixed expression:

race against the clock = 爭分奪秒；與時間競賽

It means:

try to finish something as quickly as possible because very little time remains

The speaker kept leaving tasks until the last minute, so they had to work extremely quickly before deadlines.

中文翻譯：

我總是在**和時間賽跑 / 爭分奪秒**，經常把事情拖到最後一刻。

So here, **clock** does not simply mean the physical object 「時鐘」. It represents:

the limited amount of time available before a deadline

1. **clock (時鐘) — 時鐘 ; 鐘**

The core literal noun sense.

Practice 1

> There's a **clock** on the wall.

牆上有一個**時鐘**。

Practice 2

> I looked at the **clock** and realised I was late.

我看了看**時鐘**，才發現自己遲了。

Practice 3

> The **clock** stopped at midnight.

那個**時鐘**在午夜停了。

MCQ-ready definition:

clock = 用來顯示和量度時間的裝置

2. **alarm clock — 鬧鐘**

Practice 1

> My **alarm clock** goes off at seven every morning.

我的**鬧鐘**每天早上七時響。

Practice 2

> I forgot to set my **alarm clock**.

我忘了設定**鬧鐘**。

MCQ-ready definition:

****alarm clock = 可以在設定時間發出聲響，把人叫醒或提醒人的時鐘****

3. ****digital / wall / grandfather clock — 電子鐘 / 掛鐘 / 座地大鐘****

Practice 1

> The kitchen has a large ****wall clock****.

廚房有一個大型****掛鐘****。

Practice 2

> The old house had a beautiful ****grandfather clock****.

那間老屋有一座漂亮的****座地大鐘****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****X clock = 按外形、用途或顯示方式分類的時鐘****

4. ****against the clock — 爭分奪秒****

This is the key expression in your passage.

Practice 1 — original sentence

> I was always ****racing against the clock****.

我總是在****和時間賽跑****。

Practice 2

> We were working ****against the clock**** to finish the report.

我們為了完成報告而****爭分奪秒地工作****。

Practice 3

> Doctors worked ****against the clock**** to save him.

醫生****爭分奪秒****搶救他。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****against the clock = 在時間非常有限的情況下，盡快完成某事****

5. ****race against the clock — 與時間競賽；爭分奪秒****

Practice 1

> The team was ****racing against the clock**** to meet the deadline.

團隊正****爭分奪秒****趕上截止日期。

Practice 2

> It became a ****race against the clock****.

事情變成了一場****與時間的競賽****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****race against the clock = 因剩餘時間很少而極力加快速度完成事情****

6. ****the clock is ticking — 時間正在倒數；時間不多了****

A major figurative expression.

Practice 1

> ****The clock is ticking****, so we need to decide soon.

****時間正在倒數****，所以我們要盡快決定。

Practice 2

> With only two days left, ****the clock was ticking****.

只剩兩天，****時間已經很緊迫****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****the clock is ticking = 可用時間正在不斷減少，因此需要盡快行動****

7. ****beat the clock — 趕在限時前完成****

Practice 1

> We **beat the clock** and submitted the assignment just before midnight.

我們**趕在限時前完成**，在午夜前剛好交了作業。

Practice 2

> She managed to **beat the clock**.

她成功**趕及限時**。

MCQ-ready definition:

beat the clock = 在限定時間結束前成功完成某件事

8. **around the clock** — 晝夜不停；二十四小時不停

Practice 1

> The team worked **around the clock**.

團隊**日以繼夜地工作**。

Practice 2

> The hospital operates **around the clock**.

醫院**二十四小時運作**。

MCQ-ready definition:

around the clock = 全日二十四小時不停地

9. **round the clock** — 晝夜不停

Especially common in BrE; same essential meaning as **around the clock**.

Practice 1

> Engineers worked **round the clock** to restore the service.

工程師**日以繼夜**工作以恢復服務。

Practice 2

> Security is provided **round the clock**.

保安服務是**全天候**提供的。

MCQ-ready definition:

round the clock = continuously throughout the day and night

10. **turn back the clock** — 讓時間倒流；回到從前

Practice 1

> We can't **turn back the clock**.

我們不能**讓時間倒流**。

Practice 2

> The technology aims to **turn back the clock** on some signs of ageing.

這項技術希望可以在某些老化跡象上**逆轉時間帶來的影響**。

MCQ-ready definition:

turn back the clock = 比喻回復到以前的狀態或讓過去重新出現

11. **put / turn the clocks forward or back** — 把時鐘撥快 / 撥慢

Practice 1

> Remember to **put the clocks back** this weekend.

記得這個週末把**時鐘撥慢**。

Practice 2

> We **put the clocks forward** by one hour.

我們把**時鐘撥快一小時**。

MCQ-ready definition:

put the clocks forward/back = 調整時鐘顯示的時間

12. **clock (計時) — 記錄所用時間**

A major verb sense.

Practice 1

> She **clocked** the fastest time in the race.

她在比賽中**錄得最快時間**。

Practice 2

> He **clocked** 10.5 seconds.

他**錄得十點五秒**。

MCQ-ready definition:

clock a time = 計時並記錄某人完成事情所需的時間

13. **clock someone at X seconds — 計出某人用了 X 秒**

Practice 1

> The runner was **clocked at 11 seconds**.

那名跑手的成績被**計為十一秒**。

Practice 2

> I **clocked her at just under a minute**.

我計到她用了**不到一分鐘**。

MCQ-ready definition:

clock someone at X = 測量並記錄某人用了 X 時間

14. **clock a speed — 錄得速度；測得速度**

Practice 1

> The car was **clocked at 120 kilometres per hour**.

那輛車被**測得時速一百二十公里**。

Practice 2

> Police **clocked him at** well above the speed limit.

警方**測得他的車速**遠高於限速。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****clock someone/something at a speed = 測量並記錄其速度****

15. **clock up — 累積；錄得**

A useful phrasal verb.

Practice 1

> She has **clocked up** thousands of kilometres this year.

她今年已經**累積行駛了**數千公里。

Practice 2

> He **clocked up** twenty years with the company.

他在公司**累積工作了二十年**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****clock up X = 經過一段時間累積某個數量、距離、時間或經驗****

16. **clock in — 上班打卡**

Practice 1

> Employees must **clock in** before starting work.

員工開始工作前必須**打卡上班**。

Practice 2

> I **clocked in** at eight thirty.

我八時半**打卡上班**。

MCQ-ready definition:

clock in = 使用系統記錄自己開始工作的時間

17. **clock out** — 下班打卡

Practice 1

> I **clocked out** at six.

我六時**打卡下班**。

Practice 2

> Don't forget to **clock out**.

別忘了**打卡下班**。

MCQ-ready definition:

clock out = 記錄自己結束工作的時間

18. **clock on / clock off** — 上班 / 下班打卡

Especially BrE.

Practice 1

> He **clocked on** at nine.

他九時**打卡上班**。

Practice 2

> Workers **clock off** at five.

工人五時**打卡下班**。

MCQ-ready definition:

****clock on/off = BrE: 記錄開始 / 結束工作的時間****

19. ****clock someone / something (注意到 ; 認出) — 注意到 ; 認出****

An informal modern sense, especially BrE.

Practice 1

> I ****clocked**** him as soon as he entered the room.

他一進房間，我就****注意到他了****。

Practice 2

> She immediately ****clocked the mistake****.

她立即****留意到那個錯誤****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****clock someone/something = informal: notice or recognize someone or something****

中文：

****注意到 ; 認出 ; 察覺到****

20. ****clock someone doing something — 看見 / 察覺某人在做某事****

Practice 1

> I ****clocked him looking at my notes****.

我****注意到他正在看我的筆記****。

Practice 2

> She ****clocked me leaving early****.

她****看到我提早離開****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****clock someone doing X = 注意到某人正在做 X****

21. **clock (打 ; 揍) — 打某人一下**

An informal sense.

Practice 1

> He threatened to **clock him**.

他威脅要**揍他一拳**。

Practice 2

> She nearly **clocked me** with her bag.

她的袋差點**撞到 / 打到我**。

MCQ-ready definition:

clock someone = informal: hit someone, especially hard

This is useful for recognition but not a priority for formal IELTS production.

22. **biological clock — 生理時鐘**

A major figurative/scientific compound.

Practice 1

> Travel can disturb your **biological clock**.

旅行可能打亂你的**生理時鐘**。

Practice 2

> Light helps regulate the body's **biological clock**.

光線有助調節身體的**生理時鐘**。

MCQ-ready definition:

biological clock = 身體內控制睡眠、清醒及其他周期性活動的自然時間系統

23. **body clock** — 生理時鐘

Practice 1

> Jet lag can confuse your **body clock**.

時差可以擾亂你的**生理時鐘**。

Practice 2

> My **body clock** wakes me up at six even without an alarm.

即使沒有鬧鐘，我的**生理時鐘**也會在六時把我弄醒。

MCQ-ready definition:

body clock = 控制身體日常睡眠和活動節奏的內在時間系統

24. **internal clock** — 內在時鐘；生理計時系統

Practice 1

> Humans have an **internal clock** that responds to light.

人類有一個會對光線作出反應的**內在生理時鐘**。

Practice 2

> Her **internal clock** was still on Hong Kong time.

她的**生理時鐘**仍停留在香港時間。

MCQ-ready definition:

internal clock = 生物體內調節時間節奏的機制

25. **clock speed** — 時脈速度；時鐘頻率

A common computing sense.

Practice 1

> The processor has a higher **clock speed**.

這個處理器有較高的**時脈速度**。

Practice 2

> **Clock speed** is usually measured in gigahertz.

時脈頻率通常以 GHz 量度。

MCQ-ready definition:

clock speed = 電腦處理器執行時鐘周期的頻率

26. **clock cycle — 時鐘週期**

Practice 1

> The processor performs operations during each **clock cycle**.

處理器在每個**時鐘週期**內執行操作。

Practice 2

> Some instructions require several **clock cycles**.

有些指令需要數個**時鐘週期**。

MCQ-ready definition:

clock cycle = 電子 / 電腦系統時鐘訊號的一個完整周期

27. **clockwise — 順時針方向**

Practice 1

> Turn the dial **clockwise**.

把旋鈕向**順時針方向**轉。

Practice 2

> Move **clockwise** around the circle.

沿圓圈**順時針方向**移動。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****clockwise = 與時鐘指針移動方向相同****

28. ****counterclockwise — 逆時針方向****

Mainly AmE; BrE commonly uses ****anticlockwise****.

Practice 1

> Turn the handle ****counterclockwise****.

把手柄向****逆時針方向****轉。

Practice 2

> Rotate the object ****counterclockwise****.

把物件****逆時針旋轉****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****counterclockwise = 與時鐘指針移動方向相反****

29. ****anticlockwise — 逆時針方向****

Especially BrE.

Practice 1

> Turn the lid ****anticlockwise**** to open it.

把蓋子向****逆時針方向****轉便可打開。

Practice 2

> The wheel rotates ****anticlockwise****.

輪子****逆時針旋轉****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****anticlockwise = BrE: opposite to the direction of clock hands****

30. **clockwork** (鐘錶機械裝置) — 鐘錶機械裝置

Practice 1

> The toy is powered by **clockwork**.

這件玩具由**鐘錶式機械裝置**驅動。

Practice 2

> The old mechanism works by **clockwork**.

舊裝置使用**鐘錶機械結構**運作。

MCQ-ready definition:

clockwork = 由齒輪和發條等組成、像機械鐘一樣運作的裝置

31. **like clockwork** — 像鐘錶一樣準確；極有規律地

A very useful idiom.

Practice 1

> The train arrives at seven every morning **like clockwork**.

火車每天早上七時都**非常準時地**到達。

Practice 2

> Everything went **like clockwork**.

一切都**有條不紊、極順利地進行**。

MCQ-ready definition:

like clockwork = 非常準時、有規律或順暢地發生

32. **clockwork routine / precision** — 鐘錶般規律 / 精準

Practice 1

> The process runs with **clockwork precision**.

整個程序以**鐘錶般的精準度**運行。

Practice 2

> Their morning routine has become almost **clockwork**.

他們的早晨日程已變得幾乎**機械式規律**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****clockwork = extremely regular, predictable, and precise****

33. ****the clock starts / stops — 計時開始 / 停止****

Here ****clock**** can metonymically mean an official timing system.

Practice 1

> The ****clock starts**** when the race begins.

比賽開始時便****開始計時****。

Practice 2

> The referee ****stopped the clock****.

裁判****暫停了計時****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****the clock = 用於比賽、考試等的正式計時系統****

34. ****run down the clock — 消耗剩餘時間****

Especially sports, games, negotiations, and deadlines.

Practice 1

> The team kept possession to ****run down the clock****.

球隊保持控球以****消耗剩餘時間****。

Practice 2

> He seemed to be **running down the clock** instead of making a decision.

他似乎只是在**拖時間等限時結束**，而不是作決定。

MCQ-ready definition:

run down the clock = 故意讓剩餘時間逐漸耗盡

Important distinction 1: **clock vs watch**

clock

usually a timepiece that stays in one place.

watch

usually worn on the body.

> wall clock

> 掛鐘

> wristwatch

> 手錶

Of course, phones now blur the practical distinction, but the vocabulary distinction remains.

Important distinction 2: **against the clock vs on the clock**

against the clock

trying to finish before time runs out.

> racing against the clock

> 爭分奪秒

on the clock

time is officially being counted, especially paid work or competition.

> You're still on the clock.

> 你仍然處於**工作計時中**。

Very different.

Important distinction 3: ****against the clock vs around the clock****

****against the clock****

limited time → urgency.

****around the clock****

continuous for 24 hours → duration.

> work against the clock

> 爭分奪秒

> work around the clock

> 日以繼夜

This is an excellent MCQ trap.

Important distinction 4: ****race against the clock vs beat the clock****

****race against the clock****

the struggle/process.

****beat the clock****

successful result.

> We raced against the clock.

我們爭分奪秒。

> We beat the clock.

我們成功趕及限時。

Important distinction 5: ****clock is ticking vs deadline****

deadline

the final allowed time.

the clock is ticking

figuratively emphasizes that available time is rapidly disappearing.

A deadline can exist without someone feeling that “the clock is ticking” yet.

Important distinction 6: **clock a time vs time something**

They overlap.

time someone

measure how long they take.

clock a time

record a particular performance time, especially sport.

> She was timed at 12 seconds.

> 有人為她計時，結果是十二秒。

> She clocked 12 seconds.

> 她錄得十二秒。

Important distinction 7: **clock at a speed**

Here **clock** does not mean time.

> Police clocked the car at 130 km/h.

= police **measured** its speed.

So the semantic extension is:

clock → measuring device → measure and record

Important distinction 8: **clock in vs check in**

clock in

record that you have started work.

check in

register arrival:

* hotel

* airport

* event

> clock in at work

> 上班打卡

> check in at a hotel

> 酒店登記入住

Important distinction 9: **clock out vs sign out**

clock out

record end of paid work.

sign out

record that you are leaving/logging out, often for security or systems.

They may overlap in workplaces but are not inherently identical.

Important distinction 10: **clock someone = notice someone**

This informal use is unrelated to literal time measurement in everyday meaning.

> I clocked him immediately.

= 我立即**注意 / 認出**他。

Not:

> *我替他計時*.

Context is essential.

Important distinction 11: **clock someone = hit someone**

Another informal branch:

> He clocked him in the face.

= 他**打了他臉上一拳**。

Very different from:

> clock his speed

> 測他的速度

and:

> clock him entering

> 注意到他進來

Important distinction 12: **biological clock vs body clock**

They overlap strongly.

body clock

more everyday.

biological clock

more scientific/formal.

Both can refer to circadian timing.

But **biological clock** can also be used more broadly for age-related biological timing in everyday discussion.

Important distinction 13: **clockwise is not “towards the clock”**

It means:

the same rotational direction as the hands of a traditional clock

For most clocks viewed from the front:

top → right → bottom → left → top.

Important distinction 14: **like clockwork**

Two common nuances:

Regular:

> It happens every Monday like clockwork.

> 每逢星期一都非常規律地發生。

Smooth:

> The event went like clockwork.

> 活動進行得極順利。

The physical clock metaphor produces both **regularity** and **precision**.

Important distinction 15: **run down the clock vs waste time**

run down the clock

strategically allow a fixed amount of remaining time to expire.

waste time

spend time uselessly.

A sports team may intentionally **run down the clock** very effectively—it is not necessarily wasting time.

Family-extension note

Clock begins with the literal idea of:

a device that measures and displays time

From that core, several major semantic branches developed:

1. **physical timepiece**

- * wall clock
- * alarm clock

2. **time pressure**

- * against the clock
- * race against the clock
- * clock is ticking
- * beat the clock

3. **continuous time**

- * around the clock

4. **measuring**

- * clock a time
- * clock a speed

5. **work-time recording**

- * clock in
- * clock out

6. **informal perception**

- * clock someone = notice/recognize

7. **informal physical action**

- * clock someone = hit them

8. **biological timing**

- * body clock
- * biological clock

9. **computing/electronics**

- * clock speed
- * clock cycle

10. **direction**

- * clockwise
- * counterclockwise / anticlockwise

11. **regularity**

- * like clockwork

For your passage, the key branch is:

clock = limited available time, especially in the idiom “race against the clock”

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea	
-----	-----	-----	
clock	時鐘	timepiece	
alarm clock	鬧鐘	timed alarm	
against the clock	爭分奪秒	limited time	
race against the clock	與時間競賽	urgent completion	
the clock is ticking	時間正在倒數	time running out	
beat the clock	趕及限時	finish before time expires	
around the clock	晝夜不停	24-hour continuity	
turn back the clock	讓時間倒流	return to earlier state	
clock a time	錄得時間	measure performance	
clock at X speed	測得 X 速度	measure speed	
clock up	累積	accumulate	
clock in	上班打卡	start-work record	
clock out	下班打卡	end-work record	
clock someone	注意 / 認出某人	informal notice	
clock someone	打某人	informal hit	
biological clock	生理時鐘	biological timing	
body clock	生理時鐘	everyday biological rhythm	
clock speed	時脈速度	computing frequency	
clock cycle	時鐘週期	computing/electronics	
clockwise	順時針	direction	
counterclockwise	逆時針	AmE direction	
anticlockwise	逆時針	BrE direction	
clockwork	鐘錶機械裝置	mechanism	
like clockwork	極規律 / 極順利	precision/regularity	

| **run down the clock** | 消耗剩餘時間 | deliberately use remaining time |

For your original sentence

> I was always **racing against the clock**, leaving things until the last minute...

Here:

race against the clock = 因為把事情拖到最後一刻，所以每次都只剩很少時間，不得不爭分奪秒完成

A natural Traditional Chinese rendering is:

> 我總是在**和時間賽跑 / 爭分奪秒**，經常把事情拖到最後一刻。

The most important contrast is:

> **against the clock** = **時間不夠，要趕快做**

> **around the clock** = **二十四小時不停做**

> **beat the clock** = **最後成功趕及限時**

For this passage, **race against the clock** vividly captures the speaker's old habit of repeatedly creating last-minute time pressure for themselves.